

HomeHunter

A desktop application for finding a flat in Berlin.

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THE PRODUCT

HomeHunter collects rental adverts from nineteen publicly reachable sources and merges the same flat, listed on several portals, into a single card. Every advert is checked against the criteria the user has written down — by a fixed set of rules that names the reason for each outcome. Where a flat fits, one click drafts the letter and takes the user to the original on the provider's own site, where they read on and apply themselves. The application is under development; there is no public release yet. Builds for macOS, Windows, Linux, iOS and Android are planned.

FOR DATA PARTNERS

What we do with your data

We display your adverts inside the user's application. Every card names the source it came from. One click opens your own exposé in the user's browser — reading, applying and closing all happen on your site. HomeHunter is where the user decides which advert to look at; your site remains where they act.

What we do not do

- We do not publish your data and do not pass it on.
- We do not build a public result list of our own.
- We do not create a reusable database of your inventory.
- We do not circumvent protection mechanisms.
- We do not fill in or submit anyone else's forms.
- We do not contact landlords automatically.

What you get from it

The user reaches your advert pre-filtered: city, rent, rooms, area and the rest of the conditions are already checked, and they know why this advert fits them. Instead of many enquiries sent on the off-chance you receive a few that match the object. We stand in front of your offer, not in place of it.

INTEGRATION READINESS

The application is built on an abstraction called `ListingSource` (`src/homehunter/sources/base.py`). The principle is recorded in ADR-007: the rest of the system never learns *by which route* an advert was obtained — only that it conforms to the canonical `Listing` model.

Nineteen adapters and two different acquisition routes already work beneath that abstraction:

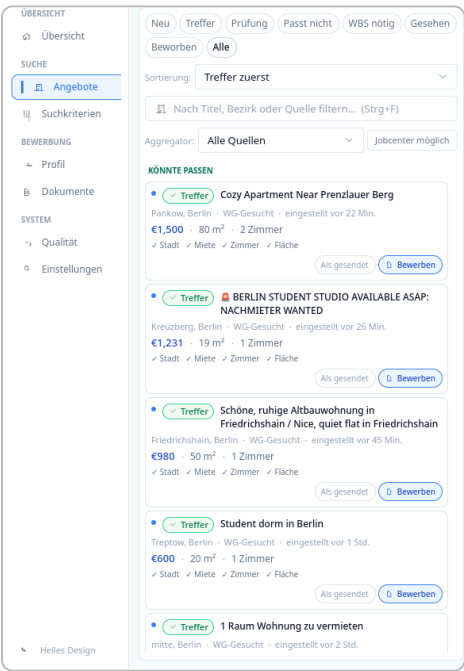
- HTTP and HTML;
- a JSON interface — `ApiRecordListingSource`, through which Vonovia, STADT UND LAND and Covivio are read.

Connecting an official interface is therefore one more adapter against an interface that already exists, not a rebuild of the system. Expect days, not months.

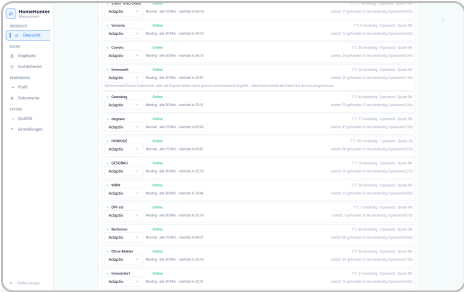
The state of ImmoScout24, without embellishment: the slot is reserved, the code is not written. The identifier `ListingSourceId.IMMOScout24` and the catalogue entry in `src/homehunter/sources/catalog.py` exist — with the domains `immobilienscout24.de` and `immoscout24.de` and the status `ACCESS_RESTRICTED`. The registration in `src/homehunter/discovery/registry.py` returns that status openly instead of feigning results. The request and the

mapping of the response will be written once a specification and access are available. For the other companies named on this page no interface adapter exists yet.

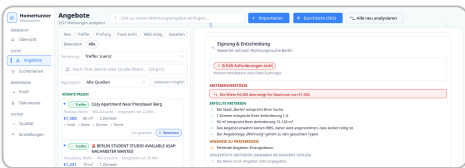
FROM THE APPLICATION



The list. Every flat found, matches first. Each card names the source, the verdict and the criteria behind it. "2 Quellen" means the same flat appeared on two portals and has been merged into one card. "Bewerben" puts a draft letter for this one advert on the clipboard and opens the original at the provider; the user sends it there themselves. "Als gesendet" is a note they make for their own record.



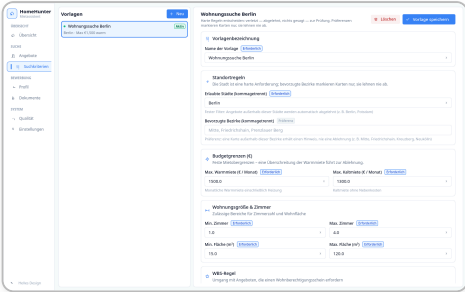
The sources and their state. Each source with its reachability, check interval and yield. What cannot be read is listed with the reason rather than simply missing.



The verdict and its reasons. A flat that is ruled out: the rent is over the limit. Every checked condition stands on its own – broken, met, or left unanswered by the advert.



Provenance. Every object carries the source it came from and the address of the original exposé. One click opens it in the user's browser.



The search criteria. The rules everything is checked against – hard limits kept apart from mere preferences. There are no others: what is not here influences no verdict.

HOW IT WORKS

- LINK**
The search collects links to the newest adverts from every registered source.
- OPEN**
Each link is opened once – over HTTP or through the source's JSON interface.
- READ**
Rent, rooms, area, address and conditions are read and converted into one common model.
- DEDUPE**
The same flat on several portals is merged into one card; every link is kept.

5 PRÜFEN

A set of rules compares the advert with the user's criteria. The outcome: it fits, it needs a look, or it is out — with the reasons in each case.

6 NUTZER

This is where the application stops. It drafts the letter, puts it on the clipboard and opens the original on the provider's own site. Reading, editing and sending happen there and are done by the user — the program never does it for them.

TRY IT YOURSELF

Six sample adverts, checked against the criteria below. Decide for yourself first — drag the card to the right if you would apply, to the left if you would not. The card then shows how the rules decide, and on what grounds.

CRITERIA

Berlin

1–3 rooms

30–90 m²

max. €950 base rent

max. €1,250 total

no WBS held

Sample data, not real adverts. The kind of source is named on each card so it stays clear which corner of the market an advert comes from. The verdict is computed by your browser, by the same rules the application applies — nothing is transmitted and nothing is stored.

SOURCES

The sources that are read			
Source	Type	Route	Hits per run
Gewobag	municipal	HTTP/HTML	~42
degewo	municipal	HTTP/HTML	~10
HOWOGE	municipal	HTTP/HTML	~28
GESOBAU	municipal	HTTP/HTML	~6
WBM	municipal	HTTP/HTML	~8
Berlinovo	municipal	HTTP/HTML	~30
STADT UND LAND	municipal	JSON interface	~15
Vonovia	private	JSON interface	~15 of 72 records
Covivio	private	JSON interface	not recorded separately
Ohne-Makler	private	HTTP/HTML	~24
DPF eG	cooperative	HTTP/HTML	0–3
Immowelt	portal	HTTP/HTML, result cards	~23–25
WG-Gesucht	portal	HTTP/HTML	~79
immobilien.de	portal	HTTP/HTML	20
Immobilie1	portal	HTTP/HTML	~15
markt.de	classifieds	HTTP/HTML	~13
Wunderflats	furnished	HTTP/HTML	~59
HousingAnywhere	furnished	HTTP/HTML	~46
Spotahome	furnished	HTTP/HTML	~96

Nineteen sources, verified live on 24 and 28 August 2026. "Hits per run" is the size of one bounded run, not the size of the source's inventory.

What official access would improve

Source	State today	What official access achieves
ImmoScout24	Not read at all. Without a partner interface the search answers HTTP 401, and the terms of use prohibit automated queries.	The single largest source on the Berlin market, currently missing entirely.
meinstadt.de	Registered but not readable: search, sitemap and robots.txt all answer HTTP 403.	A dead row in the source list becomes a living source.
Immowelt (AVIV Group)	Only the search result cards can be read; the exposé pages sit behind DataDome. Immonet redirects into the same inventory.	Full exposés instead of truncated cards — and Immonet through the same access. The largest gain in data quality per single key.
WG-Gesucht	Works, but only three pages per run are read over plain HTTP, and an advert's publication time is not available.	Higher limits and the publication time, meaning a measurable speed of response.
Wunderflats, HousingAnywhere, Spotahome	Work by parsing HTML, which breaks with every redesign of the page.	Reliability and a stable contract instead of parsing someone else's page structure.

LIMITS

No circumvention of protection mechanisms

Sources with bot protection or purely client-side rendering are recorded as unavailable and are not worked around. The error type `ComplianceBlockedError` is a regular outcome in the source code and not an exceptional case; `sources/base.py` records that a source never silently falls back to scraping when no permitted route exists. The decision on ImmoScout24 is documented in `pocs/a_immoscout/RESULT.md`.

No third-party forms

HomeHunter fills in no form on your site and submits nothing. The application drafts a letter from what the user has entered about themselves and puts it on the clipboard; reading, editing and sending are done by the user, with you, by your own route. The draft follows fixed rules too: only what the profile actually states gets written — no placeholder, no plausible invention, and where it remains open how the rent will be covered the application says so to the user rather than guessing. What is reversible is automated. What is not reversible stays with the person.

Deterministic

The verdict comes from a set of rules that names every point it checked. There are no neural networks in the application.

Data protection

The user's data stays on their device: a local SQLite database in the operating system's data directory. There is no HomeHunter server on which advert or user data would be collected. Processing takes place in the EU and follows the GDPR.

TECHNOLOGY

Python 3.13, PySide6 with QML, SQLite, Playwright, Alembic; version 1.0.0. The suite holds 1120 tests, alongside type checking with mypy and linting with ruff.

STATUS AND CONTACT

HomeHunter is under development. There is no public release yet and the source code is not open. There is no company behind the project — one person.

Enquiries about data or interface access are welcome directly:
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www.homehunter.store

IMPRESSUM

Information pursuant to § 5 TMG

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Responsible for the content under § 18 (2) MStV: Damian Lapiha, address as above.

DATA PROTECTION

The controller within the meaning of the GDPR is the person named above.

This page is static. It sets no cookies, loads no fonts, maps or scripts from third-party addresses, and measures no behaviour. The only thing the browser keeps is the chosen language (`localStorage`, key `hh-lang`); it stays on the device. The card deck in “Try it yourself” runs in the browser and transmits nothing.

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